Abraham Ogol

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SUMMARY

Hands-on senior software engineer and technology leader with 11+ years building enterprise platforms and products across Africa and international markets. Designed and developed backend services, REST APIs, microservices and distributed systems supporting 250+ enterprise customers across five African markets. Delivered 50% performance gains, 20% infrastructure cost savings and deployment cycles under 10 minutes, with hands-on expertise in Python, cloud platforms, testing, debugging, payments, identity and AI-enabled systems.

EXPERIENCE

CHIEF TECHNOLOGY OFFICER

March 2025 - Present

Cognativ Technology Ltd

- Led a 40-person engineering and platform organization across product, architecture, DevOps, QA, and security; introduced weekly execution reviews and ownership models that improved delivery accountability and increased team throughput by 60%.
- Implemented CI/CD and test automation standards, reducing deployment time from hours to under 10 minutes and cutting production defects by 45%, which improved release confidence and reduced operational incidents.
- Guide distributed-system designs across payments, billing, identity, notifications and APIs, prioritizing traceability, resilience, data protection and safe failure handling.
- Partner with product, finance and operations on roadmaps, build-vs-buy decisions and investment sequencing, balancing scale, risk, cost and team capacity.
- Moved AI into production-oriented workflows through JARVIS, coding agents, RAG and MCP for deployment, support, monitoring and security scanning, with human review of high-impact changes.
- Lead architecture and code reviews, debugging, API/database troubleshooting and performance analysis, using hands-on findings to improve engineering standards and production reliability.

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT SPECIALIST

August 2024 - February 2025

Go City

- Translated requirements into technical designs and executable backlog work; aligned architecture and integration decisions with user, operational and scalability needs.
- Coordinated implementation, API integration, testing and release readiness, maintaining shared delivery priorities across product and engineering.
- Improved release practices, documentation and handover; used production feedback to guide post-launch improvements.

PRODUCTS DEVELOPMENT LEAD

May 2022 - May 2024

CSquared

- Scaled the technology organization from 5 to 50+ professionals by building hiring, onboarding, and leadership systems that reduced onboarding time by 40% and improved ramp-up consistency across teams.
- Improved platform performance by 50% and reduced infrastructure costs by 20% through backend, architecture, resource, and cloud optimisation.
- Led platforms serving 250+ enterprise customers and integrating 6,000+ network nodes/devices across five African markets.
- Directed API-driven platforms and microservices across application architecture, cloud, databases and containers, coordinating delivery and production support across markets.
- Strengthened engineering quality through architecture and code reviews, automated testing, Agile delivery, CI/CD and release discipline.
- Led connectivity-on-demand using Software-Defined Networking and a hardware-independent SD-WAN platform built on universal CPE architecture.

MANAGER – ENTERPRISE SOLUTIONS DESIGN & IMPLEMENTATION

March 2021 - July 2022

Safaricom PLC

- Led solution design across AWS, Azure, VMware, OpenStack, APIs, identity, IoT and security, translating customer requirements into scalable architectures.
- Owned architecture trade-offs, system topology, cloud/hybrid choices, integration designs and implementation sequencing.
- Led and mentored architects and technical specialists through architecture reviews, escalations, problem resolution and technical handover.
- Aligned sales, engineering, integration and customer teams from requirements and pre-sales scoping through deployment.

IOT ENGINEER – PLATFORMS & PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT July 2019 - April 2021
Safaricom PLC

- Built a telecom base-station management platform that contributed to a 25% reduction in operational costs.
- Automated customer and operational workflows, contributing to a 12.5% revenue increase.
- Designed IoT hardware and API-first platforms for SIM activation, suspension, billing and customer workflows; provided production troubleshooting and engineering guidance.

PYTHON SOFTWARE ENGINEER & LEARNING FACILITATOR March 2018 - June 2019
Andela

- Mentored and trained 15+ developers monthly in Python, backend engineering, software design, testing, debugging and clean code.
- Built and supported Python applications, REST APIs, database services and engineering tools; used code reviews, unit/integration testing and debugging to deliver clean, maintainable backend software.

PYTHON SOFTWARE ENGINEER TEAM LEAD 2015 - 2018
AARL

- Led Python backend delivery from requirements through deployment, including REST APIs, data models and databases.
- Owned sprint planning and technical discussions; mentored engineers in architecture, debugging and problem-solving.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
Maseno University

SKILLS

Project and Product Management, Engineering Management, Agile Development, Enterprise Solution Architecture, Product strategy, API Development, .NET, Python, NodeJs, AngularJs, Databases, AI/LLM Systems (AI agents, RAG, MCP), Software Defined Networking, Cloud Computing, VMware, GCP, AWS, Kubernetes, Identity and access management, Disaster Recovery, DevSecOps, Business Acumen, Growth Mindset, Team Leadership

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

Docker Certified Associate (DCA)

Microsoft Azure Architect Design

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

Cisco Certified Design Professional

Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) Certifications

Zscaler Private Access (ZPA) Certifications

LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

- Optimized .NET architecture, improving system performance by 50% and reducing infrastructure costs by 20%.
- Introduced engineering standards and testing frameworks, decreasing production defects by 45%.
- I led agile development teams with an impressive 95% completion rate and month-on-month feature releases.
- Led the design, development, and implementation of an innovative on-demand connectivity platform integrating SDN technology to existing network infrastructure, enabling secure and flexible connectivity solutions for more than 250 clients across 5 countries.
- Led the design and development of hardware-independent SD-WAN platform leveraging the standard use of universal CPEs.
- Pioneered the design and implementation of a SIM management portal for automating IoT SIM card processes at Safaricom, optimizing the customer journey and increasing the revenue by 12.5%.
- Developed a Telecom Base Station management platform integrating several site components which helped reduce the site operation costs by 25%.